

DA2026_PRJ2: Compiler Register Allocation

Graph-Coloring Heuristics

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Outline

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- **Goal:** Implement a compiler back-end tool for global register allocation.
- **Approach:** Graph-coloring heuristics.
- **Pipeline:**
 - 1 Parse live ranges from 3-address intermediate representation.
 - 2 Build **live webs** (merging overlapping ranges).
 - 3 Construct an **interference graph**.
 - 4 Assign webs to N available registers.
- **Fallback Strategies:** Spilling, Splitting, and a Hybrid "Free" strategy when allocation fails.

The Graph Class: Conceptual Decisions

- **Base Structure:** Utilized the generic `Graph<T>` and `Vertex<T>` templates provided in practical classes.
- **Alterations & Additions:**
 - **Undirected Semantics:** Interference graphs are inherently undirected. Edge additions ensure symmetry ($A \rightarrow B$ and $B \rightarrow A$).
 - **Node/Edge Removal:** Utilized `removeVertex` to dynamically simulate web spilling and graph simplification.
 - **Incoming Edges Tracking:** Added `getIncoming()` and indegree management to support bidirectional edge analysis.

Spilling Heuristic (T2.2)

- **Objective:** Move uncolorable webs to memory to reduce graph chromatic number.
- **Spill Metric:** $\frac{\text{Degree}(\text{Node})}{\text{Live_Range_length}(\text{Node})}$
- **Rationale:**
 - High degree: removes maximum interference.
 - Short live range: minimizes memory load/store overhead.
- Iterates from 1 to K spilled webs, stopping when the graph becomes N -colorable.

Splitting Heuristic (T2.3)

- **Objective:** Divide a web into two smaller webs to reduce localized interference.
- **Maximum Interference Bottleneck:**
 - Analyzes internal execution points of the uncolorable web.
 - Finds the specific program line with the highest simultaneous interference.
- **Rationale:** Splitting at this exact point severs the most edges in the interference graph in a single operation.

"Free" Algorithm Strategy (T2.4)

- **Dynamic Efficiency Threshold Approach.**
- Evaluates the web with the highest degree when an impasse is reached.
- **Split Efficiency Metric:** $\frac{\text{Live_Range_length}(\text{Node})}{\text{Degree}(\text{Node})}$
- **Adaptive Decision Making:**
 - **Spill:** If efficiency $< 1.5/N$ (dynamic cutoff) or web spans ≤ 2 lines.
 - **Split:** If efficiency is above the threshold.
- Prevents fragment pollution from over-splitting highly connected, short-lived webs.

- **Web Construction & Merging:**

- Handling continuous vs. discontinuous live ranges accurately.
- Merging variables with overlapping scopes efficiently $O(R^2 \cdot L)$.

- **Splitting Logic:**

- Ensuring semantic correctness when dividing a web (part 1 & part 2).
- Efficiently rebuilding the interference graph after topological changes.

- **Hybrid Strategy Tuning:**

- Balancing the heuristics to correctly identify when to Spill vs. Split.

Time for a Live Demo!

- **Interactive Mode:** We will run our allocator using the step-by-step interactive menu.
- **Test Cases:** Resolving a sample dataset of live ranges and available registers.

Conclusion

- Successfully implemented a robust register allocator using graph coloring.
- Extended the base `Graph` class for advanced heuristic support.
- The "Free" strategy optimally balances spills and splits.